Beachfront Bliss

In a city that often feels at war with its own coastline, Bastian Beach Club in Juhu offers a long-overdue beachside escape. Come for the stunning sunset; stay for the drinks, the vibe and the delightful drama that unfolds.

Nivedita Jayaram Pawar







In Mumbai, we've mastered the art of the rooftop, but we've always remained strangely disconnected from our own shoreline. Bastian's latest outpost at the Sun-n-Sand aims to correct that. This newest kid on the block attempts to reclaim the coast and bring to Juhu the kind of glamour and day-bed luxury associated with the beach clubs of Saint-Tropez. "Mumbai has a lovely beach, but no beach culture," founder and CEO Ranjit Bindra tells me. It's a fair point. Until now, watching a Juhu sunset usually involved navigating a sea of corn-on-the-cob vendors and dodging the occasional stray cricket ball. Bindra's dream was to offer an international alternative. "When Sun-n-Sand happened, I could finally execute it," he says.

What's it like?

Interior designer Minal Chopra, Bindra's long-time collaborator, has delivered a striking Inka-chic aesthetic. Inside, arched pillars and heavy chandeliers create the atmosphere of a glamorous cavern. Outside, however, is where the energy shifts; Chopra has ditched the predictable blue-and-white of beach clubs for a bold orange. There is a pool taking centrestage (available for a dip at a ₹2,000, if you fancy a public splash), but the real magic is further down. I found myself under a canopy of palm trees that looked so convincing I was halfway through a compliment before I realised they were faux. Beneath them, however,